



Understanding Your Paycheck

Job Readiness • read a realistic sample pay stub

FOR STAFF • 30-MINUTE SESSION

Purpose: Teach gross pay, deductions, net pay, hours, and checking a paycheck.

Materials: Packet + calculator optional.

Easy flow: 5 min vocabulary • 15 min pay-stub detective • 5 min math • 5 min discussion.

Sample Pay Stub

EMPLOYEE	Jordan Lee	PAY PERIOD	Sept. 1-14
RATE	\$15.00/hr	HOURS	32.0
GROSS PAY	\$480.00	FEDERAL TAX	\$22.00
SOCIAL SECURITY	\$29.76	MEDICARE	\$6.96
OTHER DEDUCTION	\$12.00	NET PAY	\$409.28
YTD GROSS	\$2,340.00	PAY DATE	Sept. 18
DIRECT DEPOSIT	Checking ****2184	STATUS	Part-time
EMPLOYER	Riverbend Market	LOCATION	Tennessee

Pay Stub Detective

What is Jordan's hourly rate?

How many hours were worked?

What is gross pay? _____

How much actually went to Jordan?

How much was taken out in the listed deductions?

Why is net pay lower than gross pay?

What should Jordan do if the hours look wrong?

Paycheck Math Challenge

You work 24 hours at \$14.50/hr. Estimate gross pay.

You work 30 hours at \$16/hr. Estimate gross pay.

Your gross pay is \$525 and deductions total \$61.40. What is net pay?

Your timecard says 27 hours but your pay stub says 24. What information should you gather before contacting payroll? _____

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Get Them Talking

- Would you notice if your check was \$20 short?
- What deduction surprised you most?
- Why should you keep pay stubs?